

Prospect of Jan. 6 pardons divides D.C.

Congress torn over Trump vow to free rioters

By Kevin Freking
ASSOCIATED PRESS
WASHINGTON — The fourth anniversary of the Jan. 6 attack on the Capitol has a new focus as lawmakers brace for the prospect that President-elect Donald Trump may soon pardon many of the more than 1,500 people charged with crimes for their actions related to the riot. Trump said he would issue pardons to rioters on “Day 1” of his presidency, which begins

Jan. 20. “Most likely, I’ll do it very quickly,” he said recently on NBC’s “Meet the Press.” He added that “those people have suffered long and hard. And there may be some exceptions to it. I have to look. But, you know, if somebody was radical, crazy.” His promise, made throughout his campaign for the White House, is shadowing events Monday as lawmakers gather to certify a presidential election for the first time since 2021, when Trump’s supporters breached the Capitol and temporarily halted the certification of an election he lost to Democrat Joe Biden. Representative Marjorie Taylor, **JAN. 6, Page A7**

\$1.5 billion
more collected from the surtax on high-income earners than budgeted. Some was dedicated to child care grants and, as required under the law, nearly \$200 million was put into a reserve.
\$1.32 billion
roughly what is left of the so-called innovation and capital fund that could go toward capital projects and one-time investments, specifically in education or transportation.

Pressing challenges await on Beacon Hill

Officials must tackle cash crunch for shelters, escalating audit fight

By Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF
Oaths are taken, the pomp and circumstance is complete. And almost immediately, a cascade of challenges is tumbling onto Beacon Hill, from an emergency shelter system running dry of funding to a long-gestating audit fight that may entangle three branches of state government. The calendar offers little re-

spite for Governor Maura Healey or the state Legislature, where lawmakers are days removed from wrapping their last session in a flurry; none currently have committee assignments, and first-year members are still awaiting a permanent office. Healey officials have warned the state only has “sufficient funding” to support the strained shelter system through late January, though how much she’ll

seek to bolster it remains to be seen. Healey and lawmakers also have to decide how to spend \$1.3 billion in “excess” money the state collected from the so-called millionaires tax amid uneasy financial times for school systems, colleges, and the MBTA. And on Friday, the day a new state law took effect giving state Auditor Diana DiZogio the authority to probe the Legislature, she told legislative leaders in a letter that she intends to probe “high-risk areas,” such as pro- **BEACON HILL, Page A3**



With their father Andy Suarez in the background, Sarah Suarez, 17, shared a kiss and an embrace with her 7-year-old sister, Sofia, outside Cambridge’s Kennedy-Longfellow School, which is set to close at the end of the school year.

An uneven balancing act

Cambridge’s plan for diversity in schools falls far short of its goal

By James Vaznis
GLOBE STAFF

CAMBRIDGE — Two decades ago, Cambridge embarked on a novel approach to integrating its schools, using family income rather than race to help determine which schools students attend. It was hailed as a promising way to achieve socioeconomic and racial diversity, since students of color disproportionately live in low-income households, while also preserving a family’s right to choose where to educate their children. But that novel approach has fallen well short of its goal. There are such wide disparities in how students from different racial and socioeconomic status are assigned that Cambridge now has one of the most segregated schools in the state: the Fletcher Maynard Academy, where the population is more than 90 percent of students of color. Located roughly between Central and Kendall squares, Fletcher Maynard draws many students from nearby public housing, and consequently 70 percent of students are from low-income families. By contrast, the Baldwin School, located near Lesley and Harvard universities, has only 20 percent of students from low-income families, while **CAMBRIDGE, Page A5**



Only about 200 students attend the Kennedy-Longfellow School, which has capacity for 700.

Patriots fire Jerod Mayo after dismal 4-13 season

Head coach out after one year; win in final game costs team top draft pick

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

The Patriots fired coach Jerod Mayo on Sunday after a lone, dismal season. The news came barely an hour after the team finished the 2024 season with a 4-13 record, squandering the No. 1 pick in the draft with a 23-16 victory over the Bills at Gillette Stadium. “After the game today, I informed Jerod Mayo that he will not be returning as the head coach of the New England Patriots in 2025,” Patriots owner Robert Kraft said in a statement. “For me, personally, this was one of the hardest decisions I have ever made. I have known Jerod for 17 years. He earned my respect and admiration as a rookie in 2008 and throughout his career for his play on the field, his leadership in the locker room, and the way he conducted himself in our community.” Mayo is the only coach who has been told he is not returning. However, according to a league source, most of the coaching staff is not expected to be retained. The organization now must conduct a search for its third head coach in three years and 16th in franchise history. Former Patriots linebacker Mike Vrabel, who interviewed with the Jets last week, is a prime candidate. The Patriots circumvented such a search after parting ways with Bill Belichick in 2024 because Kraft had contractually established a succession plan for Mayo to take over as coach. The Patriots initially expected to promote Mayo in 2025, according to a league source, before the team’s 4-13 record in 2023 expedited the timeline. **PATRIOTS, Page C5**



Mayo’s firing means a search for a new coach.

LOUD AND CLEAR



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Patriots fans at Gillette Stadium on Sunday displayed their unhappiness with Jerod Mayo’s performance as head coach. More coverage, plus Dan Shaughnessy’s and Tara Sullivan’s takes in **Sports, C1.**

Norwood presses for reopening of hospital

Says health care needs going unmet since 2020 closing

By Robert Weisman
GLOBE STAFF

The abrupt closure of Steward Health Care hospitals this summer left medical buildings shuttered in Dorchester and the small Middlesex County town of Ayer. Other communities, in Brighton, in Southeastern Massachusetts, and in the Merrimack Valley, are still adjusting to new operators that acquired their community hospitals. But the legacy of Steward’s tumultuous 14-year reign continues to play

out in Norwood and a dozen surrounding cities and towns. Officials there are now stepping up their pressure on Governor Maura Healey’s administration to back the reopening of the 215-bed Norwood Hospital, which Steward evacuated after a flash flood in 2020. The fate of the 105-year-old institution, once one of the few profitable hospitals in the Steward system, will help determine the shape of the state’s health care landscape in the post-Steward era. Where the hospital once stood is a construction site with a new hospital partly built. “This is an urgent situation,” said Representative Stephen Lynch, who **NORWOOD, Page A5**



A chilly sol

Monday: Mostly sunny. High 30-35, low 17-22.
Tuesday: Sunny, breezy. High 27-32, low 17-22.
Obituaries, **B6.**
Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

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The state Legislature is welcoming 20 new members. Five to watch are profiled. **B1.**

Chick-fil-A restaurants will not be coming to Mass. Pike service areas because the chain closes on Sundays. **D1.**

Higher Social Security payments are coming for millions of public employees under a bill signed Sunday by President Biden. **A2.**

Ukrainian forces have gone on the offensive in Russia, in what appeared to be an effort to regain the initiative there. **A4.**

Awards went to “The Brutalist” for best drama, “Emilia Pérez” for best musical or comedy, and “Shogun” for best TV drama at the Golden Globes. **C10.**